



► Fleeing conflict

A mother holds her child as she arrives along with other immigrants and refugees to the Greek island of Lesbos in 2016, after being rescued by Frontex and Greek coast guards.



"NO ONE LEAVES
HOME UNLESS HOME
IS THE **MOUTH**
OF A SHARK."

WARSAN SHIRE, POET AND VOICE FOR REFUGEES

Convention expanded its framework to include refugees from all nations. Most member nations within the UN signed the 1967 Convention, which defines the status of refugees and grants them the right to move freely, receive education, and work. However, many signatory nations have since tried to prevent refugees from reaching their own borders.

Historic displacement

After World War II, more than 11 million people were displaced as they fled genocide or the path of combat. Displaced persons camps (DPCs) were created to shelter these refugees—not only in Europe, but also in Egypt, Palestine, and Syria. These camps accommodated refugees from parts of Eastern Europe such as Bulgaria and Yugoslavia, where people had fled from the advances of the Russian Army, as well as Greece and Turkey. Families in these DPCs—some of the biggest of which were Nuseirat, in Gaza, and El Shatt, in Egypt—were kept together, but single men and women were housed separately. Men and women alike were expected to work, and women took on roles such as shopkeeper, cleaner, and seamstress; some even took up vocational training in the camps as nurses. In addition to this, women in the camps also performed the domestic work, such as laundry, cooking, and mending. Many refugees fleeing from the East to the West during the decolonization of Africa, and later Asia and the Americas, did not receive a

warm welcome. In the 1950s, 200,000 refugees fled Algeria for France during the nation's independence uprising against the French. Previously, most Algerians immigrating to France were men, but from

